Unit 12 — Year Review: A Class Podcast

Track E · Klasse 7 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can speak for ~90 seconds about something I learned this year using past, present, and future structures.*
- *I can use a wide range of grammar from the year (simple past, used to, present perfect, past perfect, futures, modals, passives) in one short text.*
- *I can listen to a peer's 90-second monologue and give one specific piece of feedback.*

Lead-in I

Ms. Reyes set up two microphones in the corner of the classroom. ”This is the studio,” she said. ”Today, every one of you records ninety seconds. The question on the wall is the question.” On the wall, in big letters, she had written: *What is one thing you learned this year that wasn’t on the timetable?*

Reading I

Listening — *Looking Back, Looking Forward*
Aisha. What's the one thing you're proudest of this year?
Ben. I learned to read a short story without being annoyed. Last year I would have given up by page two.
Marius. I used to think I couldn't speak English in front of anyone. I still get nervous, but I can do it now.
Aisha. Mine is small. I asked a question in class without writing it down first.

The 90-second monologue — structure
A clear short monologue has three movements:

Reading II

1. **Then.** Where I was at the start of the year. (1–2 sentences, simple past or *used to*.)
2. **Now.** What changed; what I can do now. (2–3 sentences, present perfect / present simple.)
3. **Forward.** One thing I will do or try next. (1 sentence, *will / going to / would like to*.)

Reading III

Plus one **concrete detail** that anchors the piece (a real moment, a real text, a real person).

Sample monologue (Niveau M, ~95 seconds)
At the start of Klasse 7 I used to write English with German word order. My sentences sounded translated. I have spent the year doing two things differently: I read one short English text every week — even if it's only the back of a cereal box — and I have written one paragraph every Friday in my notebook. I'm not perfect — I still mix up tenses when I'm tired — but my writing now sounds like English, not like German wearing an English coat. Next year, I'm going to read one short story a month from Project Gutenberg. I would like the writing to start sounding like *me*, not just like English in general. That's the next step.

Practise I

Niveau G — controlled
A. Year-review grammar mix. Fill in the correct form.

1. Last September I _____ (be) nervous about Klasse 7.
2. I _____ (improve) my listening this year.
3. I _____ (read) two short stories before the end of the year.
4. Next year, I _____ (try) public speaking.

Practise II

Niveau M — productive
B. Build the three-movement frame. In your notebook, write three short sentences:

5. *Then.* In September, I ___ .
6. *Now.* I have ___ .
7. *Forward.* Next year, I'll ___ .

C. Peer-feedback frame. Write one sentence using each frame to give to a partner about their monologue:

Practise III

- *I noticed that …*
- *One thing that worked was …*
- *One thing you could try is …*

Your turn I

Class podcast — *What I Learned That Wasn't on the Timetable*. Each student records a **90-second monologue** using the three-movement structure (Then → Now → Forward) plus one concrete detail.
Three rules:

1. *No reading word-for-word from the page.* Bullets only.
2. *One concrete detail* — a real text, a real person, a real moment.
3. *Listen to a partner's recording* and give one feedback sentence using the *I noticed / worked / could try* frame.

Your turn II

The teacher collects the recordings into one class file.
For Niveau G: 60 seconds is enough. Provide a printed three-line template with the *Then / Now / Forward* labels in place.

Reflect I

- I can speak for 60–90 seconds with a clear three-movement structure.
- I can give a peer one specific piece of useful feedback.
- I can name one thing I learned this year that wasn't on the timetable.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Sounds — *Short Cuts* (short audio essays, very accessible models for monologue structure). https://www.bbc.co.uk/programmes/b04dmxwl
- The Moth — *True stories told live*. Pick a 5-minute story for upper-Niveau-M learners. https://themoth.org
- ESL Pod — *News in Easy English* for listening practice over the holidays. https://www.eslpod.com